Thong Pham

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EDUCATION

University of Colorado, Boulder — **Boulder, CO**
Master of Science: Computer Science (**Specialization: Machine Learning, GPA 4.0 / 4.0**) — *June 2024 - December 2025*

University of California, Irvine — **Irvine, CA**
Bachelor of Arts: Business Economics — *September 2019 - December 2022*

WORK EXPERIENCE

Mercor — **San Francisco, CA**
Software Engineer & Tooling — *March 2025 - Present*

- Built Python tooling that runs **GPT-5**, **Gemini**, and **other LLM APIs** to automatically validate dataset and label quality for multiple AI labs, increasing testing throughput by **~40% and accelerating R&D cycles**.
- Designed and maintained data pipelines from **Snowflake** into **Hex**, delivering analysis dashboards that track model performance and label coverage, **cutting manual data processing time by ~25%**.
- Engineered end-to-end **data labeling workflows** like intake, QA feedback, reviewer handoffs, and merge to standardize **quality checks** and **acceptance criteria**, improving labeler throughput and maintaining **<1% post evaluation defect rates.**
- Served as a quality **SME** for **LLM evaluation workflows**, resolving ambiguous requirements, clarifying acceptance criteria, and providing guidance on edge cases to reviewers and project **Strategic Project Lead (SPL)**.

Software Engineer LLM

- Resolved hundreds of LLM and data-related issues each week across Python, Java, and C/C++ services; debugged API integration paths and rate limiting to reduce incident noise for AI lab partners.
- Maintained a **first-pass fix rate above 99%** while ensuring all code changes met strict guidelines required by top AI research labs, resulting in significantly shortened review cycles.
- Collaborated with **research scientists** and **product managers** to clarify ambiguous data requirements, define key edge cases, and produce implementation-ready technical specifications with clear acceptance criteria, **reducing feature iteration time by 20%**.
- **Reviewed evaluator outputs** against project guidelines, identified recurring quality issues, and provided actionable feedback to improve reviewer consistency and adherence to acceptance criteria.

Kashmir World Foundation — **Richmond, VA**
Machine Learning Engineer Intern — *September 2024 - February 2025*

- Utilized **XGBoost**, **PyTorch**, and **OpenCV** on large-scale bioacoustic data (over 200K audio/video clips) to **achieve 91.6% classification accuracy**, demonstrating end-to-end data ingestion, hyperparameter tuning, and deployment.
- Performed exploratory data analysis (EDA) and feature selection (random forests, correlation analysis) on complex **signal-based** datasets to enhance model interpretability for domain experts.
- Created interactive **Power BI** and **Tableau** dashboards to present modeling insights and trend analyses, informing conservation researchers and decision-makers on species behavior.

Stealth Startup — **Irvine, CA**
Software Engineer — *February 2023 – June 2024*

- Delivered **LLM-based** features for **finance workflows** when teams needed reliable automation on **transaction data**; owned **prompt design**, **API orchestration**, and **output post-processing** in **Python** using **hosted model APIs** to ship end-to-end.
- Improved confidence in **LLM behavior** as prompts and logic evolved across core **financial use cases** like **report generation**, **risk/exception handling**; built lightweight **evaluation scripts** to benchmark outputs and show degradations during iteration.
- Reduced recurring release issues in **LLM-powered finance features** when changes caused inconsistent outputs; built a **Python regression test harness**, curated representative **transaction scenarios**, and converted **production bugs** into repeatable **test cases** to validate prompt and post-processing updates before **deployment**, improving release confidence and reducing repeat incidents.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming Languages: Python (TensorFlow, Scikit-learn, Keras, PyTorch, Seaborn, OpenCV), R, Java, C/C++, SQL.
Tools & Frameworks: Git (CI/CD), PowerBI, Tableau, Airtable, Docker, Excel, Google Sheets, Google Workspace.
Data Engineering & Big Data: AWS (S3, EC2), Google Cloud (GCP), Snowflake.
Language: English (Native), Vietnamese (Native), Spanish (Intermediate).